

SOUTH INDIA A BEACON OF HIGHER EDUCATION EXCELLENCE

South India, renowned for its rich cultural heritage and diverse traditions, has emerged as a prominent hub of higher education excellence in the last several decades, with a special focus on technical and professional education. The reasons for this are manifold.

Since ancient times, Southern India has been a centre of education. This legacy has now been carried on to the present. Add to that external factors like excellent connectivity, a peaceful socio-cultural milieu and English as the prevalent medium of studies and you have all the makings of a thriving education hub.

Educational institutions in the region pride themselves on excellent standards of education and good placement records. South India's spend on higher education has been the highest. With high literacy rates, the region also enjoys some of the best Gross Enrolment Ration (GER) and Pupil-Teacher Ratio in India. Cities like Chennai, Coimbatore, Bengaluru, Mysuru and Hyderabad are major educational hubs and both public and private universities offer excellent courses and attract meritorious students.

Among the southern states, Tamil Nadu shines prominently as a hub for advanced learning, attracting students from across the nation. As an education hub, Tamil Nadu has always attracted students for the quality of education especially in the engineering and technical streams with a proven record in academics, a special focus on inclusive education and outstanding results in job placements across engineering colleges and universities providing good education quality. One of the most literate states in India, Tamil Nadu consistently leads in the NIRF rankings of the top 100 colleges in India and offers degrees in coveted disciplines like Medical, Engineering, Management, Law, Architecture and Mass Communications.

According to the recently released All India Survey on Higher Education by the Ministry of Education, Government of India, Tamil Nadu's GER (the number of students enrolled in higher education as a percentage of the eligible population aged 18 to 23 years) was 47 per cent. According to the report, GER is “a key indicator of the level of participation in higher education within a given population. Higher GER values indicate greater enrolment in higher education among the specified age group”. For comparison, the all-India average GER was 28.4 per cent in the 2021-22 period. Tamil Nadu has consistently maintained the highest GER among the larger Indian states.



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Historical and Cultural Legacy

The roots of South India's prominence in higher education can be traced back to its rich